Independent Project Guidelines 2025

The Independent Project (IP) is a crucial component of the academic program at TamTam Digital School, designed to allow students to demonstrate their expertise through applied research or professional practice. This document outlines the comprehensive guidelines for the IP, which have been updated for the 2025 academic year.

The IP serves as a capstone requirement, enabling students to consolidate their training and apply their knowledge to address real-world challenges. Through the IP, students will have the opportunity to analyze a problem, develop a methodological approach, and present their findings in a structured format.

The guidelines detail the purpose, structure, and expectations of the IP, ensuring alignment with modern academic standards. The project aims to develop key competencies, including analytical skills to address professional or research-based problems, proficiency in designing and implementing a research or intervention methodology, the ability to synthesize existing knowledge and derive actionable insights, and effective communication of results through written and oral presentations.

The IP is structured to guide students through a series of stages, from the initial problem identification and research design to the final presentation of findings. Specific formatting requirements are provided to ensure a consistent and professional approach.

The evaluation of the IP will be based on a comprehensive set of criteria, taking into account the student's ability to analyze the problem, develop a well-designed methodology, synthesize relevant information, and effectively communicate their findings. The assessment will also consider the overall quality, originality, and potential impact of the project.

By completing the Independent Project, students at TamTam Digital School will have the opportunity to demonstrate their expertise, apply their knowledge to real-world challenges, and develop essential skills that will be valuable in their future careers or further academic pursuits.

TamTam Digital School

Cover Page

Institution Name: TamTam Digital School

Logo: [Insert Institution Logo]

Title: Your theme's title

Student Name: [Your Name]

Academic Program: [Your Program]

Academic Year: 2026

Date: Insert Date

TamTam Digital School

Abstract

[Write your Abstract]

List of Figures

- Figure 1: Name of figure (Page [Reference])

List of Tables

- Table 1: Name of Table (Page [Reference])

List of Acronyms

- IP: Independent Project
- APA: American Psychological Association

Acknowledgements

[Write your Acknowledgements]

Summary

[Write your summary]

Tam Tam Digital School

Introduction

[Write your Introduction]

Objectives

[Write your objectives]

Stages of the Independent Project

The IP is an iterative process requiring regular consultation with faculty advisors. Key stages include:

1. **Problem Definition**: Identify a specific issue or question within your field and articulate its significance.
2. **Research Questions and Hypotheses**: Formulate clear questions and testable hypotheses or objectives.
3. **Literature Review**: Conduct theoretical investigations to contextualize your work and support your hypotheses.
4. **Methodology**: Select and justify appropriate approaches, tools, and methods for data collection and analysis.
5. **Analysis and Interpretation**: Analyze results and interpret findings in the context of your research questions.

Figure 1: Project Workflow Diagram

[Insert a diagram illustrating the project stages here]

Tam Tam Digital School

Structure of the Independent Project

The IP report must include the following components:

1. **Preliminary Parts**:
    - Cover Page
    - Abstract (150–250 words)
    - List of Figures, Tables, and Acronyms
    - Acknowledgements
    - Executive Summary
2. **Introduction**:
    - Problem Statement
    - Literature Review
    - Objectives
3. **Development**:
    - Theoretical Framework
    - Methodology
    - Results and Analysis
    - Discussion
4. **Conclusion and Recommendations**
5. **Bibliographical References** (APA 7th edition or equivalent)
6. **Appendices** (e.g., data tables, questionnaires)
7. **Table of Contents**

Tam Tam Digital School

Details of the Structure of the Independent Project

Preliminary Parts

1. **Cover Page:**
    - Pages: 1
    - Reason: A single page containing the institution logo, project title, student name, program, and date, as per the template.
2. **Abstract (150–250 words):**
    - Pages: 1
    - Reason: At 150–250 words, the abstract fits comfortably on one page, typically with a word count yielding ~0.5–0.8 pages of text, leaving space for the title and formatting.
3. **List of Figures, Tables, and Acronyms:**
    - Pages: 1–2
    - Reason:
    - List of Figures/Tables: If the project includes a moderate number (e.g., 5–10 figures/tables), this fits on ~0.5 pages.
    - List of Acronyms: A short list (e.g., 5–15 acronyms) takes ~0.25–0.5 pages.
    - Combined, these may span 1 page if concise or 2 if more extensive or formatted with extra spacing.
4. **Acknowledgements:**
    - Pages: 1
    - Reason: Typically a brief section (100–200 words) thanking advisors, peers, or institutions, fitting within one page.
5. **Executive Summary:**
    - Pages: 1–2
    - Reason: An executive summary (300–500 words) summarizes the project's purpose, methods, and findings. At ~250–300 words per page, this typically spans 1 page but may extend to 2 if more detailed or formatted with headings.

Tan Tan Digital School

Total Preliminary Parts: 5–7 pages

Introduction

6. **Problem Statement:**
    - Pages: 1–2
    - Reason: The problem statement (300–600 words) clearly defines the issue and its significance. This typically fits within 1–2 pages, depending on the complexity and inclusion of background context.
7. **Literature Review:**
    - Pages: 3–5
    - Reason: A thorough review of relevant literature (900–1500 words) synthesizes existing knowledge and identifies gaps. At ~250–300 words per page, this spans 3–5 pages, depending on the depth and number of sources cited.
8. **Objectives:**
    - Pages: 1
    - Reason: The objectives (150–300 words) concisely outline the project's goals and scope, fitting within 1 page.

Total Introduction: 5–8 pages

Development

9. **Theoretical Framework:**
    - Pages: 3–5
    - Reason: This section (900–1500 words) establishes the theoretical basis for the project, discussing key concepts and models. It typically spans 3–5 pages, depending on the complexity and inclusion of diagrams or tables.

Tam Tam Digital School

10. **Methodology:**
    - Pages: 3–5
    - Reason: The methodology (900–1500 words) details the research design, tools, and procedures. Including descriptions of methods, data collection, and analysis, this section spans 3–5 pages, with potential for tables or flowcharts.
11. **Results and Analysis:**
    - Pages: 4–6
    - Reason: Presenting and analyzing results (1200–1800 words) requires space for data (e.g., tables, figures) and narrative explanation. This section typically spans 4–6 pages, with figures or charts potentially increasing page count.
12. **Discussion:**
    - Pages: 4–6
    - Reason: The discussion (1200–1800 words) interprets results, compares them to the literature, and addresses implications. This section spans 4–6 pages, depending on depth and integration of references.

Total Development: 14–22 pages

Conclusion and Recommendations

13. **Conclusion and Recommendations:**
    - Pages: 2–3
    - Reason: This section (600–900 words) summarizes findings, draws conclusions, and offers actionable recommendations. It typically spans 2–3 pages, allowing for a concise wrap-up and forward-looking insights.

Total Conclusion and Recommendations: 2–3 pages

TamTam Digital School

Formatting Guidelines

To ensure clarity and professionalism, adhere to the following standards in Microsoft Word:

- **Font**: Times New Roman or Calibri, 12pt.
- **Line Spacing**: 1.5 lines for the main text; single spacing for captions and footnotes.
- **Margins**: 1-inch margins on all sides.
- **Pagination**:
    - Use Roman numerals (i, ii, iii, etc.) for preliminary parts.
    - Use Arabic numerals (1, 2, 3, etc.) for the main body and appendices.
    - Place page numbers in the footer, centered.
- **Citations**: Follow APA 7th edition or another standard citation style
- **File Format**: Save and submit the final report as a .docx or PDF file
- **Headings**: Use Word's "Styles" feature for consistent heading levels (e.g., Heading 1 for sections, Heading 2 for subsections).
- **Tables and Figures**: Insert using Word's "Insert Table" and "Insert Picture" functions, with captions formatted in single spacing.

TamTam Digital School

Evaluation Criteria

The IP will be assessed based on the following criteria:

Table 1: Evaluation Criteria for the Independent Project

Category	Criteria
Content	
Originality	Novelty and relevance of the theme
Literature Review	Depth of understanding and critical engagement
Problem Formulation	Clarity of problem statement and hypotheses
Methodology	Appropriateness and rigor of methods
Synthesis	Coherence and strength of argumentation
Results	Quality and relevance of findings
Form	
Clarity	Readability and logical flow
Language	Adherence to grammar and spelling standards
Formatting	Compliance with project guidelines
References	Accuracy and consistency of citations

TamTam Digital School

Submission Process

- Submit the final IP report and supplementary materials (e.g., datasets, presentation slides) via email
- Label all files clearly with your name and project title (e.g., “LastName_FirstName_IP_2025.jpg” or “LastName_FirstName_IP_2025.fig” or “LastName_FirstName_IP_2025.zip” or “LastName_FirstName_IP_2025.docx” or “LastName_FirstName_IP_2025.pdf”, etc.).

Appendices

Include supplementary materials such as raw data, survey instruments, or additional figures here.

Table of Contents

[Insert Word’s automatic Table of Contents here: References > Table of Contents > Automatic Table 1]

Tam Tam Digital School